



Inspection Report

Wellington Conservation Center
14990 Palm Beach Point Blvd
Wellington, FL 33414

Customer ID: **329044**

Certificate: **58-C-1207**

Site: 001

Wellington Conservation Center

Type: ROUTINE INSPECTION

Date: 30-APR-2026

2.40(b)(2) Critical

Attending veterinarian and adequate veterinary care (dealers and exhibitors).

The facility failed to notify the attending veterinarian after a female prairie dog stopped eating on Friday April 3rd and subsequently died the next day. An employee reported the animal's condition to the licensee via text message on the morning of Saturday April 4th. The licensee texted the employee stating she texted the attending veterinarian. However, after talking to the attending veterinarian, the attending veterinarian stated that the licensee knows she does not offer emergency care on the weekends. The animal died later that day on April 4th.

Effective and timely communication between licensees, their employees, and the attending veterinarian is essential to safeguarding the health and welfare of all animals. Prompt updates and collaboration can prevent problems from escalating—many illnesses can be addressed quickly and effectively with immediate notification to the veterinarian. All licensees are required to maintain veterinary coverage at all times, including weekends and holidays.

Each dealer or exhibitor shall establish and maintain programs of adequate veterinary care that include the use of appropriate methods to prevent, control, diagnose, and treat diseases and injuries, and the availability of emergency, weekend, and holiday care. To be corrected this day, April 30, 2026, forward.

2.40(b)(3)

Attending veterinarian and adequate veterinary care (dealers and exhibitors).

The facility failed to identify and address an eye lesion in an adult Crab-eating male raccoon. During a routine inspection, USDA inspectors observed an approximately 6mm circular lesion on the animal's right eye. The lesion appeared cloudy and blue in color, with a central indentation. Inspectors also observed cloudiness in both eyes. When questioned, the facility representative stated that this condition was "normal for him" because of his cataracts. Inspectors consulted with the attending veterinarian, who agreed it appeared to be a new corneal lesion. The attending veterinarian also stated that the animal has a history of cataracts in both eyes and was treated for a similar corneal lesion in 2023 but had not undergone any treatment or evaluation since that time.

Failure to closely observe animals on a daily basis may result in significant behavioral or physical changes going unnoticed. This can delay the identification of illness or injury, leading to prolonged discomfort and inadequate or untimely veterinary care. Daily and attentive observation of all animals is essential to identify early indicators of illness, injury, or

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distress.

Each dealer or exhibitor shall establish and maintain programs of adequate veterinary care that include daily observation of all animals to assess their health and well-being. To be corrected this day, April 30, 2026, forward.

3.75(c)(3)

Housing facilities, general.

There is a build up of dried fecal matter on a tire swing in an enclosure housing 7 black-and-white ruffed lemurs.

Failing to maintain clean conditions in areas accessible to nonhuman primates can lead to significant accumulations of debris and contaminants, increasing the risk of disease and compromising the health and welfare of the animals housed there in.

Hard surfaces with which nonhuman primates come in contact must be spot cleaned daily and sanitized in accordance with 3.84 of this subpart to prevent accumulation of excreta or disease hazards. Contaminated material must be removed or replaced whenever raking and spot cleaning does not eliminate odors, diseases, insects, pests, or vermin infestation. Correct by May 1, 2026.

3.75(e)

Repeat

Housing facilities, general.

Food used to feed non-human primates was not stored properly. Apples, carrots, squash, and corn were stored in the door of the refrigerator without being placed in a leakproof container with a tightly fitting lid. The inside walls and shelves of the refrigerator were dirty and spattered with food material. The seals were dirty and contained mold in some areas. There was a colony of ants seen marching across the top of the refrigerator door.

Improper food storage can reduce nutritional value and palatability. Open food items must be kept in leakproof, tightly sealed containers to prevent spoilage, contamination, and pest infestation.

Food requiring refrigeration must be stored accordingly, and all food must be stored in a manner that prevents contamination and deterioration of its nutritive value. Open food and bedding supplies must be kept in leakproof containers with tightly fitting lids to prevent spoilage and contamination.

3.84(d)

Repeat

Cleaning, sanitization, housekeeping, and pest control.

The facility does not currently maintain an effective pest control program. There is a large quantity of rodent droppings on bookshelves and throughout the room housing a black and white ruffed lemur and in the garage that acts as the main food prep and storage area for the facility. While the facility does set traps, it is not effective in managing the rodent population.

Pests such as rodents and insects can introduce pathogens, parasites, and environmental contaminants that pose direct

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health risks to animals. Contaminated feed or water can also diminish animal welfare, reduce nutritional quality, and create stressful or unsafe living conditions.

An effective program for control of insects, external parasites affecting nonhuman primates, and birds and mammals that are pests, must be established and maintained so as to promote the health and well-being of the animals and reduce contamination by pests in animal areas.

3.125(a)

Repeat

Facilities, general.

The metal gates housing pigs are in disrepair. Two metal gates housing a total of three pigs in two separate enclosures are eaten away by rust on the bottom bar, leaving sharp, ragged edges.

Rusted, sharp metal can easily cause cuts or puncture wounds to people or animals passing through or working near the gate. It also weakens the gate's structural integrity, making it more likely to bend, break, or fail under normal use which may lead to animal escape.

The facility must be constructed of such material and of such strength as appropriate for the animals involved. The indoor and outdoor housing facilities shall be structurally sound and shall be maintained in good repair to protect the animals from injury and to contain the animals.

3.153(a)(2)

Primary enclosures.

There is a wooden pallet in disrepair in a duck's enclosure. A wooden pallet elevating a swimming pool in an enclosure containing one duck has broken boards with sharp edges.

Broken boards are dangerous because they create sharp edges, splinters, and unstable surfaces that can easily injure a bird. Even a small fracture in a perch, platform, or crate can lead to cuts or punctures, foot and leg injuries, snags or entanglement, stress or behavioral changes as the animal tries to avoid the unsafe area.

Furniture-type objects, such as perches and other objects that enrich a bird's environment, must be species-appropriate and be designed, constructed, and maintained so as to prevent harm to the bird. Correct by May 1, 2026.

This inspection and exit interview were conducted with the facility representative.

Additional Inspectors:

Colette Kirk El-Amin, VETERINARY MEDICAL OFFICER

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Species Inspected

Cust No	Cert No	Site	Site Name	Inspection
329044	58-C-1207	001	Wellington Conservation Center	30-APR-2026

Count	Scientific Name	Common Name
000008	<i>Varecia variegata</i>	BLACK-AND-WHITE RUFFED LEMUR
000001	<i>Bos taurus</i>	CATTLE / COW / OX
000003	<i>Sus scrofa domestica</i>	DOMESTIC PIG / POTBELLY PIG / MICRO PIG
000004	<i>Vulpes pallida</i>	PALE FOX
000002	<i>Hydrochaeris hydrochaeris</i>	CAPYBARA
000001	<i>Potos flavus</i>	KINKAJOU
000001	<i>Dolichotis patagonum</i>	PATAGONIAN CAVY / MARA
000001	<i>Procyon cancrivorus</i>	CRAB-EATING RACCOON
000003	<i>Choloepus hoffmanni</i>	HOFFMANN'S TWO-TOED SLOTH
000004	<i>Notamacropus rufogriseus</i>	BENNETT'S WALLABY / RED-NECKED WALLABY
000002	<i>Varecia rubra</i>	RED RUFFED LEMUR
000001	<i>Cynomys ludovicianus</i>	BLACK-TAILED PRAIRIE DOG
000002	<i>Tamandua tetradactyla</i>	SOUTHERN TAMANDUA
000005	<i>Capra hircus</i>	DOMESTIC GOAT
000002	<i>Procyon lotor</i>	RACCOON
000002	<i>Hystrix cristata</i>	AFRICAN CRESTED PORCUPINE
000002	<i>Anas platyrhynchos domesticus</i>	DOMESTIC DUCK INCLUDING ALL DOMESTIC BREEDS
000001	<i>Struthio camelus</i>	COMMON OSTRICH
000002	<i>Lemur catta</i>	RING-TAILED LEMUR
000047	Total	